

DIRECTIONS *for questions 1 to 4:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

Scientists find it difficult to know which facts are important and which irrelevant, unless they already have a framework or theory into which they could fit the facts. This is not being 'unscientific' in any way. Scientists do not work with unambiguous facts, they have to place facts in context, to interpret them within a particular framework or theory. In cosmology or atomic physics, this process is relatively uncontroversial. But when we are dealing with the question of human nature/origins, the creation of the framework within which one places the facts can be contentious, and open to political, philosophical and cultural influences. Virtually all our evolutionary theories about human origins are relatively unconstrained by fossil data. They have often said far more about the theorists than about what actually happened.

Today, the questions of 'how and when did we become human?' remain culturally loaded. The key issue for many Darwinists is the similarity of humans and apes. Humans share 98 percent of their genes with chimpanzees. If we take away our clothes, possessions and language, observes Jared Diamond, then we begin to look like an ape...Humanity without their humanity are revealed to be 'what they really are'. Diamond's argument is that 'what we really are', the essence of humanity, has little to do with conventional indices of humanness: language, culture, technology, and so on. Rather it is expressed principally through our animal heritage.

The genetic proximity of Man and ape is without question. One could say, given the tiny genetic difference, that our humanity does not lie in our genes. Or one could argue we are little more than another ape, and the roots of our behaviour must lie in our animal, and in particular ape, ancestry. In adopting the second argument, Darwinists like Diamond are doing more than taking an objective look at the human condition. They are interpreting the scientific data through a particular philosophical lens. They are projecting their vision of what it means to be human on to the data.

For all Robert Foley's protestations, then, that evolutionary questions are merely technical ones, Darwinian explanations also draw on philosophical and cultural assumptions about what constitutes humanity, how humans relate to the non-human animal world. If the Victorian insistence on a biological chasm between man and ape originated from an almost mythical belief in human progress, today's insistence that humans are nothing more than another kind of ape is the consequence of a century's worth of disillusionment with such optimism. Foley notes: The history of the twentieth century has transformed our vision of humanity, leading to a 'loss of confidence in the extent to which humans could be said to be on a pedestal above the swamp of animal brutishness.'

The almost boundless capacity of humans to do damage to each other has, in the twentieth century, rather dented human self-esteem. Apes have become more angelic; the angels, or at least their human representatives, more apish. Originally, humans were thought to be the advanced form of life (the angels), and other animals the more primitive, now it may be argued that the animal within us is our noble side, and humanity the darker side – a complete reversal of the original Victorian image.

Q1. Which of the following correctly points out the difference in the field of cosmology and evolutionary biology as discussed in the first para of the passage?

- ☐ a) In the former, one does not work with unambiguous facts while in the latter, theorists work with ambiguous facts that are influenced by philosophy and culture.
- ☐ b) In the former, theories are twisted to suit facts while in the latter, facts are twisted to suit theories.
- ☐ c) In the former, the creation of the framework within which one places the facts is less controversial than that in the latter.
- ☐ d) In the former, one considers it a capital mistake to theorize before one has data while in the latter, one projects contemporary concerns onto the past.

Q2. What is the style of the passage?

- ☐ a) Narrative
- ☐ b) Analytical
- ☐ c) Descriptive
- ☐ d) Argumentative

Q3. In the author's opinion,

- ☐ a) Jared Diamond implies that the essence of humanity lies in our inherited traits.
- ☐ b) Jared Diamond believes that clothes, possessions, culture, technological and linguistic prowess are the distinguishing features of humanity.
- ☐ c) man's genetic similarity to apes leads him to behave in a beastly manner.
- ☐ d) if an ape wore clothes and could talk, it would be indistinguishable from man.

Q4. Which of the following stories pertaining to today's times would be told by a Darwinist to highlight the essence of humanity?

- ☐ a) The story of humanity expressed principally through our animal heritage
- ☐ b) The tale of the fall of man back into beastliness
- ☐ c) The story of the descent of Man and the ascent of humanity
- ☐ d) The story of the convergence of the human and ape evolutionary tree lines

DIRECTIONS *for questions 5 to 8:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

A set of straight and gleaming teeth makes for a beautiful smile. But how many people who have undergone a little dental maintenance know that they may have inside their mouths some of the first products of a new industrial revolution? Tens of millions of dental crowns, bridges and orthodontic braces have now been produced with the help of additive manufacturing, popularly known as 3D printing. Forget the idea of hobbyists printing off small plastic trinkets at home. Industrial 3D printers, which can cost up to \$1m, are changing manufacturing.

The business of dentures shows how. For the metal bits in false teeth, dentists have long relied upon a process called “investment casting”. This involves creating an individual model of a person’s tooth, often in wax, enclosing it in a ceramic casing, melting out the wax and then pouring molten metal into the cavity left behind. When the cast is split open, the new metal tooth is removed. It is fiddly, labour-intensive and not always accurate.

Things are done differently at an industrial unit in Miskin, near Cardiff, set up by Renishaw, a British engineering company. The plant is equipped with three of the firm’s 3D printers; more will be added soon. ... The machines use a laser to steadily melt successive layers of a cobalt-chrome alloy powder into the required shapes. The process ... can take eight to ten hours, but the printers run unattended and make each individual tooth to a design that is unique to every patient. Once complete, the parts are shipped to dental laboratories all over Europe where craftsmen add a layer of porcelain. Some researchers are now working on 3D printing the porcelain, too.

The mouth is not the only bodily testing-ground for 3D-printed products. Figures gleaned by Wohlers Associates, an American consultancy that tracks additive manufacturing, show that more than 60m custom-shaped hearing-aid shells and ear-moulds have been made with 3D printers since 2000. Hundreds of thousands of people have been fitted with 3D-printed orthopaedic implants, from hip-replacement joints to titanium jawbones, as well as various prosthetics. An untold number have benefited from more accurate surgery carried out using 3D-printed surgical guides; around 100,000 knee replacements are now performed this way every year.

That the health-care industry has so swiftly adopted additive manufacturing should be no surprise. People come in all shapes and sizes, so the ability of a 3D printer to offer customised production is a boon. The machines run on computer-aided design (CAD) software, which instructs a printer to build up objects from successive layers of material; a medical scan in effect functions as your CAD file. And software is faster and cheaper to change than tools used in a traditional factory, which is designed to churn out identical products. ...

Materials companies are coming up with more and more specialised ingredients for additive manufacturing. Alcoa, a leading producer of aluminium, recently said it would supply Airbus with 3D-printed titanium fuselage parts, 3D-printed fuel nozzles for jet engines and 3D-printed pylons used to attach engines to wings. In the future, large 3D printers will be used not only to print smartphones and portable consumer electronics but also to print cars, or at least much of their structure, using a blend of plastic and carbon fibre.

Q5. “But how many people who have undergone a little dental maintenance know that they may have inside their mouths some of the first products of a new industrial revolution?” What does the author mean when he poses this question?

- ☐ a) People are not bothered to know about the technology involved in dentistry unless they have a beautiful smile.
- ☐ b) 3D printing technology is too complicated for people to understand.
- ☐ c) Only people looking for a prospective business in 3D printing pay attention to its technology.
- ☐ d) People are still unaware of the multiple applications of 3D printing.

Q6. What can be inferred from “more will be added soon” in para 3?

- ☐ a) People at Miskin are more prone to dental problems and hence 3D printing of dental crowns, bridges and orthodontic braces is more in demand over there.
- ☐ b) With the growing demand for 3D printing, the requirement for 3D printers is increasing.
- ☐ c) Employees at the British Engineering Company are not efficient in managing 3D printers and hence more automation is the need of the hour.
- ☐ d) More 3D printers will be required in case the existing 3D printers become defunct or run out of order.

Q7. Which of the following is true with reference to 3D printing?

- ☐ a) 3D printing has been successful in carrying out very complex cardiac surgeries.
- ☐ b) Additive manufacturing was already on par with and has now supplanted conventional processes.
- ☐ c) Because 3D printing is cheap, it might not be a good business prospect for current investors.
- ☐ d) 3D printing is well suited to the field of healthcare since products can be turned out that are specific to the particular requirements of individuals.

Q8. All of the following have been mentioned in the passage as examples of 3D-printed industrial products that are currently used EXCEPT?

a. Hearing-aid components

b. Titanium jawbones

c. Knee-replacement and hip-replacement joints

d. Plastic trinkets

e. Aircraft fuselage components

f. Mobile phones

☐ a) e and f

☐ b) c, d, e and f

☐ c) a, b, d and e

☐ d) d and f

DIRECTIONS *for questions 9 to 12:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

A compelling narrative fosters an illusion of inevitability. Consider the story of Google. Two creative graduate students in the computer science department at Stanford University come up with a superior way of searching information on the Internet. ... Within a few years, the company they started is one of the most valuable stocks in America. On one memorable occasion, they were lucky, which makes the story even more compelling: a year after founding Google, they were willing to sell their company for less than \$1 million, but the buyer said the price was too high. Mentioning the single lucky incident actually makes it easier to underestimate the multitude of ways in which luck affected the outcome.

...Fleshed out in more detail, the story could give you the sense that you understand what made Google succeed and what makes businesses succeed. Unfortunately, there is good reason to believe that your sense of understanding and learning from the Google story is largely illusory. The ultimate test of an explanation is whether it would have made the event predictable in advance. No story of Google's unlikely success will meet that test, because no story can include the myriad of events that would have caused a different outcome.

The human mind does not deal well with non-events. That many important events involved choices further tempts you to exaggerate the role of skill and underestimate the part that luck played in the outcome. Because every critical decision turned out well, the record suggests almost flawless prescience—but bad luck could have disrupted any one of the successful steps. The halo effect adds the final touches, lending an aura of invincibility to the heroes of the story.

Like watching a skilled rafter avoiding one potential calamity after another as he goes down the rapids, the unfolding of the Google story is thrilling because of the constant risk of disaster. However, there is an instructive difference between the two cases. The skilled rafter has gone down rapids hundreds of times. He has learned to read the roiling water in front of him and to anticipate obstacles. He has learned to make the tiny adjustments of posture that keep him upright. There are fewer opportunities for young men to learn how to create a giant company, and fewer chances to avoid hidden rocks. Of course, there was a great deal of skill in the Google story, but luck played a more important role in the actual event than it does in the telling of it. And the more luck was involved, the less there is to be learned.

At work here is that powerful WYSIATI rule. You cannot help dealing with the limited information you have as if it were all there is to know. You build the best possible story from the information available to you, and if it is a good story, you believe it. Paradoxically, it is easier to construct a coherent story when you know little, when there are fewer pieces to fit into the puzzle. Our comforting conviction that the world makes sense rests on a secure foundation: our almost unlimited ability to ignore our ignorance.

Q9. The author mentions 'the single lucky incident' (first para) to demonstrate that

- ☒ a) it offered distraction from the other ways luck had helped Google's meteoric rise. ✓ Your answer is correct
- ☐ b) the Google founders were lucky that the sale of their company for \$1 million didn't quite manifest.
- ☐ c) it was luck more than anything else that Google became one of the most valuable stocks in America.
- ☐ d) luck was an important element in the correctness of every single decision that the Google founders had taken.

Q10. Which of the following best summarises the paradox mentioned in the last para of the passage?

- ☐ a) **People make decisions with the limited information they have as if it is all the information that they need to make those decisions.**
- ☐ b) It is easier to ignore our ignorance when there is little information available.
- ☐ c) Coherence is more easily achieved with limited information.
- ☐ d) The fewer the pieces in a puzzle, the easier it is to put together.

Q11. The author calls one's sense of understanding and learning from the Google story largely illusory because

- ☐ a) **it is impossible for one to learn about every event that contributed to Google's rise.**
- ☐ b) no narrative for Google's story could have possibly predicted Google's success.
- ☐ c) the story of Google's success leaves out instances where fate played a part.
- ☐ d) one's understanding of Google's success is based on events where luck played a major role.

Q12. It cannot be inferred from the last para of the passage that

- ☐ a) **the world makes sense to us because of our ignorance.**
- ☐ b) our conviction depends more on the stories that we build than on the reliability of our evidence.
- ☐ c) it is possible that we do not understand the fact that we lack all the information we need to explain something.
- ☐ d) the coherence of the story we create about an event need not be proportional to the amount of possible information that exists about the event.

DIRECTIONS *for questions 13 to 16:* The passage given below is accompanied by a set of **four** questions. Choose the best answer to each question.

The contract model of political association is an attractive way for liberals to conceive of political association because it does not presuppose that political society is directed towards any substantive end or goal. ... Because the liberal state does not take a substantive view on what constitutes living well, but rather only a procedural view on how people interact within the terms of their rights and liberties, it is often described as being neutral about ultimate ends. The neutral state does not presuppose any basic values or conceptions of the good.

The concept of neutrality is a complex notion that confusingly includes what might be called neutrality of policy outcomes and neutrality of their justification i.e. the consequences of policy should not privilege any conception of the good or conceptions of ultimate values. This conception, which has been attributed to some liberals, is incoherent. Either the state prohibits abortion, privileging those who believe in the priority of rights of the unborn, or it permits abortion, privileging the rights of mothers to decide whether to carry a pregnancy to term. A policy of indifference would necessarily privilege one side or the other, as there is no third way.

A liberal policy of toleration has the effect of privileging the views of tolerant liberals over those of non-tolerant non-liberals. Liberal egalitarians are more concerned with neutrality in justification. The justification of liberal principles must emerge from a procedure that does not simply presuppose the truth of a particular conception of a good life. The really hard thing is to provide those who are not already liberal egalitarians with reasons to accept a liberal political order. Yet, liberalism does take a view on the core ethical significance of individuals. Surely this means that liberals are not neutral between those moral, political and religious doctrines that offer a more holistic account of the individual in relation to community, nation or Church? ...

Impartiality theorists do not claim that liberalism is free of any fundamental value commitments. Liberalism must give priority to equality of concern and the idea of the separatedness of persons – that individuals have ultimate moral significance and cannot be sacrificed for the good of others. Instead, they attempt to model these basic values in a way that does not presuppose any single conception of the good life.

Rawls believes that the principles of justice necessary to guarantee a fair basic structure not privileging any particular group is that set which would be agreed upon in a special agreement. However, if people are allowed to enter the agreement with full knowledge of their own position in society, they will have a tendency to bargain to maximize their own advantage. The initial agreement takes place behind the veil of ignorance which filters out from individual decision-making the biases of self-preference and partiality. Rawls' basic intuition is that fairness or impartiality can be achieved by combining ignorance with self-interest. If we do not know who we are, but we are motivated to improve our condition in life, we will choose Rawls' principles of justice.

Q13. Why is the neutrality of policy outcomes termed as an 'incoherent conception' by the author?

- ☒ a) **A policy outcome involving the inclusion of equal reinforcement of rights of everyone is not in the realm of possibility.** ✓ Your answer is correct
- ☐ b) A government will be dubbed as directionless if it ignores the conception of the good or of the ultimate values.
- ☐ c) Ideologically, it is feasible but irrational for a policy to be neutral; it is impracticable to maintain neutrality.
- ☐ d) A policy aimed at a neutral outcome can privilege only the tolerant liberals.

Q14. Which of the following best captures the meaning of the expression “neutral about ultimate ends”, taken in the context of the passage?

- ☐ a) **The ends being secular in nature.**
- ☐ b) The ends delivering a particular privilege to the state machinery but no particular advantage to any individual over the other.
- ☒ c) **The absence of any preconceived idea about what constitutes the public good.** ✓ **Your answer is correct**
- ☐ d) Everyone in the society working towards common ends.

Q15. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage?

I. Rawls believed that a veil of ignorance prevented individuals from acting selfishly.

II. The idea fundamental to the views of 'impartiality theorists' is the recognition of an individual's ethical significance.

III. Self-interest should be a principle needed to achieve impartiality as it provides the stimulus for bettering one's condition.

☐ a) **Only I and II**

☐ b) I, II and III

☐ c) **Only II and III**

☒ d) **Only I** ✗ **Your answer is incorrect**

Q16. Which of the following statements is Rawls least likely to agree with when it comes to making fair agreements?

- ☐ a) **Self-aware people, when entering into agreements, tend to bargain in a way so as to attain maximum profit.**
- ☒ b) **Partiality and self-preference can be avoided while making fair agreements only if the individuals are self-aware and have full knowledge of their position in society.**
- ☐ c) **A fair basic structure can be achieved when people who are not self-aware enter into agreements to improve their condition in life.**
- ☐ d) **Individual decision making, when not coloured by self-preference and partiality, can lead to fair agreements.**

Q17. DIRECTIONS *for question 17:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

Epistemic authority relates to the authority of those with superior knowledge in a specific field—experts. Administrative authority, by contrast, relates to those who have had authority bestowed upon them, and are thus in a position of power. For example, the police are in a position of administrative authority, according to the law of the land. Hence, if they inform you that you should drive more slowly, you should heed them because you are legally obliged to do so. By contrast, a medical doctor possesses epistemic authority pertaining to health matters. For that reason, if she were to advise me to take my medicine twice a day, I would be wise to comply, but not legally or morally obliged. I would likely comply because I perceive her to possess more knowledge than I do on the benefits of various medicine routines.

- ☐ a) While policemen are in a position of administrative authority, doctors enjoy what you call epistemic authority.
- ☐ b) Not all administrators with authority are experts, and not all experts have administrative authority.
- ☒ c) Administrative authority comprises those who are empowered by the law, while epistemic authority comprises those who are empowered by their own expertise in a subject. ✓ **Your answer is correct**
- ☐ d) While we are legally obliged to respect administrative authority, we are more likely to comply with epistemic authority because of the expertise involved.

Q18. DIRECTIONS *for question 18:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. Similarly, data from a large, real-world social network collected over a 20-year period suggests that longer-lasting moods (e.g., depression, happiness) can be transferred through networks as well.
2. Emotional contagion is well established in laboratory experiments, in which people transfer positive and negative moods and emotions to others.
3. The interpretation of this network effect as contagion of mood has come under scrutiny due to the study's correlational nature, including concerns over misspecification of contextual variables or failure to account for shared experiences, raising important questions regarding contagion processes in networks.
4. Emotional states can be transferred to others via emotional contagion, leading them to experience the same emotions as those around them.

Q19. DIRECTIONS *for question 19:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.
Sentence: *Adult-directed sports for children began to replace ‘pickup’ games; adult-directed classes out of school began to replace hobbies; and parents’ fears led them, ever more, to forbid children from going out to play with other kids, away from home, unsupervised.*

Paragraph: For more than 50 years now, we in the United States have been gradually reducing children’s opportunities to play, and the same is true in many other countries. ____ (1) ____ In his book *Children at Play: An American History* (2007), Howard Chudacoff refers to the first half of the 20th century as the ‘golden age’ of children’s free play. ____ (2) ____ By about 1900, the need for child labour had declined, so children had a good deal of free time. ____ (3) ____ But then, beginning around 1960 or a little before, adults began chipping away at that freedom by increasing the time that children had to spend at schoolwork and, even more significantly, by reducing children’s freedom to play on their own, even when they were out of school and not doing homework. ____ (4) ____ There are lots of reasons for these changes but the effect, over the decades, has been a continuous and ultimately dramatic decline in children’s opportunities to play and explore in their own chosen ways.

- ☐ a) **Option 1**
- ☐ b) **Option 2**
- ☐ c) **Option 3**
- ☐ d) **Option 4**

Q20. DIRECTIONS *for question 20:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

Human well-being can be reduced to life and health. The threats to life and health are warfare and disease. The bioanthropological approach to these problems is to show that, although they are an aspect of the human condition and hence natural in biological terms, they vary greatly among societies depending on both physical and cultural conditions. It is therefore relevant to reducing rates of mortality and morbidity to know more about the factors in human nature that augment these rates: what is general for the species, what varies genetically among populations, and what is the impact on people of conditions in the physical environment and of circumstances fashioned by the society of the particular social group.

- ☐ a) Human well-being depends on our understanding of how physical and social environment reduces mortality and morbidity rates.
- ☐ b) Our physical conditions and circumstances fashioned by our society play a big part in dealing with the threats to life and health.
- ☐ c) Knowledge of how physical and cultural conditions of societies, along with genetic similarities and variations, enhance mortality and morbidity rates can help us counter them.
- ☐ d) Threats like warfare and disease vary among societies based on the physical and cultural conditions prevailing in those societies.

Q21. DIRECTIONS *for questions 21 and 22:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

1. In this respect, Audioslave has defied convention, producing a record that sounds both classic and fresh, and more importantly, like a going concern rather than an exercise in necrophilia.
2. Few rock supergroup line-ups in recent years have had fans slavering in anticipation as much as Audioslave, the band which emerged from the ashes of Rage Against The Machine's acrimonious split with singer Zak La Rocha.
3. All too often in the case of supergroups, the resulting whole is less than the sum of its parts.
4. The notion of Soundgarden's Chris Cornell stepping into La Rocha's moccasins may have raised a few eyebrows, but it will put a smile on the faces of those who have been itching to hear Cornell put his redoubtable talents to good use again.

Q22. DIRECTIONS *for questions 21 and 22:* The sentences given in the question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence is labelled with a number. Decide on the proper order for the four sentences and key in the sequence of four numbers as your answer, in the input box given below the question.

- 1. Perhaps, too, it will be a financial crisis that signals the twilight of American global primacy.
- 2. The evolution of credit and debt was as important as any technological innovation in the rise of civilization, from ancient Babylon to present-day Hong Kong.
- 3. Corporate finance was the indispensable foundation of both the Dutch and British empires, just as the triumph of the United States in the twentieth century was inseparable from advances in insurance, mortgage finance and consumer credit.
- 4. Banks and the bond market provided the material basis for the splendours of the Italian Renaissance.

Q23. DIRECTIONS *for question 23:* There is a sentence that is missing in the paragraph below. Look at the paragraph and decide in which blank (option 1, 2, 3, or 4) the following sentence would best fit.

Sentence: *Although we tend to think of gaslighting as a problem between two people in a relationship, it also unfolds as part of an unequal social context.*

Paragraph: But even though everyone seems to be talking about gaslighting, this type of abuse is just starting to be studied using systematic social scientific data. ____ (1) ____ Gaslighting feeds off social vulnerabilities and stereotypes. ____ (2) ____ It entrenches existing power imbalances while fostering new ones. ____ (3) ____ The term is also increasingly used to describe structural racism, sexism, homophobia and ableism. ____ (4) ____ Scholars and activists have used the term “racelighting,” for instance, to name racial microaggressions that undermine the experiences of people of color and the ideologies that cover up these behaviors; a 2021 policy report described race-based gaslighting as “institutionalized in the social fabric.”

- ☐ a) **Option 1**
- ☐ b) **Option 2**
- ☐ c) **Option 3**
- ☐ d) **Option 4**

Q24. DIRECTIONS *for question 24:* The passage given below is followed by four alternate summaries. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the passage.

Some, including Aristotle, have claimed that the aim of politics, and of our political institutions, is to make us flourish. I reject that strong view, because I don't think the government should take on the project of cultivating a particular comprehensive morality. After all, we disagree about what makes a life good! I do think, however, that we need politics if we hope to live worthwhile lives — because cultivating relationships of shared ambition, love, care, support, and creativity does require a relatively stable and just social and political order. Although it's not the state's job to make us good, it is the state's job to sustain the social conditions under which we can live according to our own vision of what makes life worthwhile. And the political arrangement that most reliably supplies those conditions is democracy.

- ☐ a) **Democracy offers the conditions that allow people to live worthwhile lives.**
- ☐ b) **The aim of politics is to propagate morality through a just social and political order.**
- ☐ c) **The role of a state is to create a political arrangement where individuals can fulfil their own visions of a worthwhile life.**
- ☐ d) **A democratic government shouldn't tell people what is right and what is wrong but should create conditions that help people to make their own choices.**